FALLING FIRE EXPANDED

Statblocks, Sayings, Encounters, & Tactics

HOMEBREW

Expanding the **Falling Fire** faction in *Dungeons of Drakkenheim* for your 5e game

By: u/cordialgerm

Art Credit: Midjourney

The Falling Fire, Expanded

The Followers of the Falling Fire are a religious sect who believe the meteor signalled a celestial prophecy, and consider delerium a holy sacrament. Called to pilgrimage by the prescient testament of their leader, Lucretia Mathias, zealous masses of devout common-folk now journey to the crater's edge to take their place in a divine plan.

This document expands upon the Followers of the Falling Fire faction as outlined in the *Dungeons of Drakkenheim* campaign setting book. It includes bespoke statblocks, encounters, tactics, sayings and scriptures, items, and a discussion of faction alliances.

Design Goals

- Expanded content for a *Dungeons of Drakkenheim* campaign
- Create a unifying trait that represents the sanctification and the willingness for the Falling Fire members to sacrifice their lives
- Create a little more variety than the french-vanilla **Cultist**, **Cult Fanatic**, and **Berserker** SRD statblocks referenced by the book
- Create spellcaster statblocks with the good parts of design from *Monsters of the Multiverse* (simplified spell lists, no spell slots, powerful attacks and multiattacks, spellcasting mixed with multiattack) but that still have interesting signature spells to cast
- Create a **Lucretia Matthias** statblock that is easier for DMs to run at her full potential (she's crazy hard to run!)

Sanctified

The devout members of the Falling Fire have been **Sanctified** by undergoing the dangerous *Sacrament of the Falling Fire*, a spell outlined in *Dungeons of Drakkenheim*.

> ***Sanctified***. The sanctified gains advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, resistance to necrotic and radiant daamge, and immunity to **Contamination**.

I also wanted members of this faction have unique mechanics that really emphasize the importance of santification and the nature of the ultimate sacrifice that true believers are willing to make - their own death for the cause. Many Falling Fire statblocks have features or reactions that trigger based on the presence or death of a sanctified ally.

Minions

This supplement utilizes the **Minion** rules from *Flee Moratls! The MCDM Monster Book*. You can find these rules outlined in the ***Flee Mortals! Preview Packet***.

Sanctified Acolyte

The **Sanctified Acolyte** has found new spiritual powers awakening within themselves after completing their pilgrimage to the crater. In combat, the acolyte fights zealously. They often start combat with *Hold Person* or *Blindness/Deafness* on the target they consider the most unrighteous and will fight at range with *Holy Bolt* and *Sacred Flame*.

Sanctified Acolyte

Medium Humanoid(Human), Neutral Good

Armor Class 11 (Unarmored)
Hit Points 36 (8d8)
Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)

Skills Insight +5, Persuasion +3, Religion +2
Damage Resistances necrotic, radiant
Senses passive Perception 13
Languages Common
Challenge 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus +2**

Sanctified. The sanctified gains advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, resistance to necrotic and radiant damage, and immunity to **Contamination.**

Innate Spellcasting. The acolyte's innate spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). The acolyte can innately cast the following spells, requiring no materials components:

1/day each: *Cure Wounds (2nd), Hold Person, Blindness/Deafness*

Actions

Multiattack. The acolyte makes two Holy Bolt attacks

Holy Bolt. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, range 60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 3) radiant damage.

Sacred Flame. A target within 30 ft. that the acolyte can see must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, it takes 14 (4d6) radiant damage and is **Blinded** until the end of its next turn. On a success, it takes half as much damage and isn't blinded.

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Sanctified Zealot

The **Sanctified Zealot** is a dedicated and fervant warrior for the cause. Often, these individuals have no formal combat experience or prior martial training, but after performing sacrament they have found that their unwavering faith has manifested in renewed vigor and fanatical strength. The zealot is a close-combat brute and tank and is perfect for charging headlong into battle. The exception to this rule is if the zealot is tasked with protecting a key member such as **Lucretia Matthias**, or a **Sanctified Chaplain** such as Nathanial Flint. In such cases, the zealot remains nearby and physically interposes their body to provide protection. The zealot utilizes the *Slam* attack against enemies that appear like they would rather prefer to not be engaged in close combat. Otherwise, they attack with their *Greataxe*.

Sanctified Zealot

Medium Humanoid(Human), Chaotic Good

Armor Class 12 (Hide)
Hit Points 60 (8d8 + 24)
Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	9 (-1)	11 (+0)	9 (-1)

Skills Athletics +5
Damage Resistances bludgeoning, piercing, slashing, necrotic, radiant
Senses passive Perception 10
Languages Common
Challenge 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus +2**

Sanctified. The sanctified gains advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, resistance to necrotic and radiant damage, and immunity to **Contamination.**

Zealous. The zealot makes all attacks with advantage, and attacks against the zealot have advantage. The zealot has resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage.

Actions

Multiattack. The zealot makes two Greataxe attacks, or one Greataxe and one Slam attack.

Greataxe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d12 + 3) slashing damage plus 2 (1d4) radiant damage.

Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit*: 8 (2d4 + 3) bludgeoning damage. If the target is Large or smaller, it is **Grappled** (escape DC 13). The Zealot can only have one target grappled at a time.

Reactions

Faith Beyond Death. When reduced to 0 hp and not incapacitated, the zealot makes a Greataxe attack with advantage against a hostile target within 5 ft. If it hits, the attack deals an additional 5 (2d4) radiant damage.

Falling Fire Cultist

The **Falling Fire Cultist** is a **Minion** (see ***Flee Mortals! Preview Packet***) and always comes in groups of 5 (CR 1/2 for 5). The typical cultist is a poor penniless peasant and is not trained in combat. Nevertheless, they fight bravely and fanatically for their cause. These individuals have not yet completed the sanctification, but their *Faithful Prayers* empower their sanctified brethren. In combat, the cultists swarm whichever target their sanctified brethren are focusing on in order to boost their damage with *Faithful Prayers*.

Falling Fire Cultist (Minion)

Medium Humanoid(Human), Neutral Good

Armor Class 12
Hit Points 6
Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Senses passive Perception 11
Languages Common
Challenge 1/2 (20 XP) **Proficiency Bonus +2**

Minion. This creature is a **Minion** and follows the **MCDM Minion** rules. To summarize, 5 of this unit represent CR 1/2, each one dies in one hit, overkill damage can kill adjacent minions, and the minions perform a special group attack.

Faithful Prayers. When a hostile creature within 15 ft of one or more cultist takes radiant damage from a spell or attack originating from a Sanctified ally, then that creature takes an additional X radiant damage, *up to 5 total*, where X is the number of cultists within 15 ft. of the creature. This ability only triggers once per turn and once per such group of cultists.

Actions

Fanatical Frenze (Group Attack). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 piercing damage for each participating minion. When performing a **Group Attack**, add +1 to hit for each minion participating in the attack.

Sanctified Champion

The **Sanctified Champion** is an elite knight that has sworn themselves into the service of the Falling Fire. Many are former knights or paladins of the Silver Order who have become disillusioned with the corruption of the church and its strict hierarchy. These champions are few in number and often protect key faction locations, act as bodyguards to **Lucretia Matthias**, and are occasionally sent on important faction missions. In combat, the champion moves quickly to engage the enemy front line and protect fellow casters. It uses *Abjure the Wicked* on the target it perceives as the most evil.

Sanctified Champion

Medium Humanoid(Human), Neutral Good

Armor Class 18 (plate)
Hit Points 90 (12d8 + 36)
Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws WIS +4, CHA +5
Skills Athletics +7, Perception +4
Damage Resistances necrotic, radiant
Senses passive Perception 14
Languages Common
Challenge 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus +3**

Sanctified. The sanctified gains advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, resistance to necrotic and radiant damage, and immunity to **Contamination.**

Actions

Multiattack. The champion makes two Greatsword attacks. If both attacks hit the same target, the target must make a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked **Prone**.

Greatsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) slashing damage plus 3 (1d6) radiant damage.

Bonus Actions

Abjure the Wicked (Recharge 6). The champion calls upon the wicked to repent. One target of the Knight's choice within 30 ft. that can see or hear the knight must make a DC 13 Wisdom save. On a failure, the target is **Frightened** for 1 minute (save ends at end of turn). If the target fails the save by 5 or more, it is also **Paralyzed** while frightened in this way.

Reactions

Faith Beyond Death. When reduced to 0 hp and not incapacitated, the champion makes a Greatsword attack with advantage against a hostile target within 5 ft. If it hits, the attack deals an additional 7 (2d6) radiant damage.

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Sanctified Chaplain

The **Sanctified Chaplain** channels powerful divine magics within themselves. Many are former Flamekeepers, but some are male Pyre Priests who, now unburdened by the restrictions of the tradtional clerical structures, have awoken their inner divine magics. The chplain is a powerful ranged controller and support caster who channels the might of the sacred flame. In combat, the chaplain attemps to stay at 60 ft range and tries to open the fight with a *Flame Strike*. As the enemies close in, it attempts to control enemies with *Fear*. As allies die, it uses *Gather the Faithful* to replenish its temporary hp as well as bolster the most powerful sanctified melee combatant in range. It uses its *Holy Bolt* to push back enemies that are getting close to it to threaten it

Sanctified Chaplain

Medium Humanoid(Human), Neutral Good

Armor Class 14 (Armor of Faith)
Hit Points 72 (11d8 + 22)
Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	18 (+4)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws WIS +7, CHA +4
Skills Insight +7, Persuasion +4, Religion +3
Damage Resistances necrotic, radiant
Senses passive Perception 14
Languages Common, Celestial
Challenge 6 (2,300 XP) **Proficiency Bonus +3**

Innate Spellcasting. The chaplain's innate spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). The chaplain can innately cast the following spells, requiring no materials components:

3/day each: *Lesser Restoration, Daylight*
2/day each: *Dispel Magic, Blindness/Deafness*
1/day each: *Flame Strike, Fear*

Sanctified. The sanctified gains advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened, resistance to necrotic and radiant damage, and immunity to **Contamination.**

Actions

Multiattack. The chaplain makes two Holy Bolt attacks, or one Holy Bolt attack and uses its Spellcasting or Sacred Flame.

Holy Bolt. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +7 to hit, range 60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 18 (4d6 + 4) radiant damage. If the target is Large or smaller, it is pushed up to 10 ft away.

Sacred Flame. A target within 30 ft. that the chaplain can see must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, it takes 21 (6d6) radiant damage and is **Blinded** until the end of its next turn. On a success, it takes half as much damage and isn't blinded.

Reactions

Gather the Faithful. When a Sanctified ally dies within 60 ft., the Chaplain harnesses the strength of their conviction from within their Golden Delerium and increases the resolve of the nearby faithful. The Chaplain chooses one other Sanctified ally within 60 ft. Both the Chaplain and the chosen Sanctified ally gain 11 (2d10) temporary hp.

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Lucretia Matthias

Lucretia Matthias* is, in my opinion, the most powerful of the faction leaders presented in *Dungeons of Drakkenheim*. I think she is also the most difficult to run to her full potential. Here are some suggestions for how to play her statblock to its maximum effect.

Play Wisely

Lucretia is intelligent and extremely wise. She does not fall for common mistakes that spellcasters encounter, such as being too close to an enemy caster and getting *Counterspelled*. Assume Lucretia knows all of her enemies' spells and abilities and plays to counter them. She has discovered this over time with *Scrying* and *Commune* and her accumulated wisdom. Common threats to deal with:

Countermeasures against Common PC Tactics

- *Counterspell* - Lucretia should stay more than 60 ft away from any enemy spellcaster. If that is not possible, she should move out of line of sight of the caster before casting her spell so that it cannot be countered. If she is countered, her spell is still at 9th level and requires a DC 19 spellcasting ability check to counter
- *Grappling* - Lucretia is susceptible to being grappled. In her wisdom, she has cast *Freedom of Movement* upon herself (see below)
- *Silence* or Surrounded by Enemies - her celestial ally can always dash, fly in and pick her up, and fly her to safety
- *Feeblemind* - a *Divine Intervention* can get her out of this one
- *Being Surrounded* - Lucretia's celestial ally can always pick her up and fly her into the air
- *Wall of Force*, *Forcecage*, and *Maze* - Lucretia can counter these with *Word of Recall* or by using *Divine Intervention* to activate a concentration-free *Antimagic Field* on herself and disable the spell

Pre-Cast Buffs

Lucretia is perhaps the most prescient individual alive on the Continent. With an unheard of Wisdom of 24, Intelligence of 19, Charisma of 19, passive Insight of 27, and passive Religion of 24, you can assume that she is not easily caught unaware or unprepared. Indeed, the *Prescient* ability specifically states she cannot be caught by surprise. To play this up, you can assume that Lucretia is always aware on which days she may face mortal danger. On top of her mental ability scores, she also has *Commune* and *Scrying* to help her ascertain this knowledge.

Pre-Cast Buffs

Whenever Lucretia faces combat, she has already cast *Aid*, *Death Ward*, and *Freedom of Movement* upon herself, granting her:

- +45 HP, to a total of 135 HP (from *Aid* at 9th level)
- The first time she is reduced to 0 HP, she is instead reduced to 1 HP (from *Death Ward*)
- She is immune to **Grappled**, **Paralyzed**, and **Restrained** conditions (simplified from *Freedom of Movement*)

Maximize Divine Grace

Lucretia's *Divine Grace* ability is extremely powerful. Many characters will find it difficult to consistently make DC 20 Wisdom saves whenever they wish to target Lucretia. However, this ability only functions if Lucretia does not make attacks or effect enemies with spells. Importantly, she can still cast spells, just as long as they don't effect enemies! Lucretia should utilize this ability to its fullest and use her first actions to improve her odds in combat by casting spells that do not negate her *Divine Grace* ability. The best uses of this are *Gate*, *Holy Aura*, *Heal* and *Divine Intervention*.

Use Gate Early

Gate is Lucretia's combat-oriented 9th level spell. On a day when she may face mortal peril, you can assume she foregoes casting the *Sacrament of the Falling Fire* and reserves her 9th level spell slot for *Gate*. She is described as wearing a Delerium necklace on a chain around her neck. This can act as the material component for the *Gate* spell. She should use this as soon as possible to summon a **Planetar** or a **Deva**. Her celestial ally can use its *Healing Touch* on her to keep her alive, if needed. Once the *Gate* is activated and the Celestial has come through, she can cast a different concentration spell such as *Spirit Guardians*, *Hold Person*, *Banishment*, or *Holy Aura*.

Crowd Control

A 9th level *Hold Person* or *Banishment* can be devastating on PCs as it can target the entire party. Lucretia should bust this out once the *Gate* has opened. She uses *Banishment* if there are any summoned creatures or if she is outnumbered, and prefers *Hold Person* if she has allies nearby so that they can get in the critical hits.

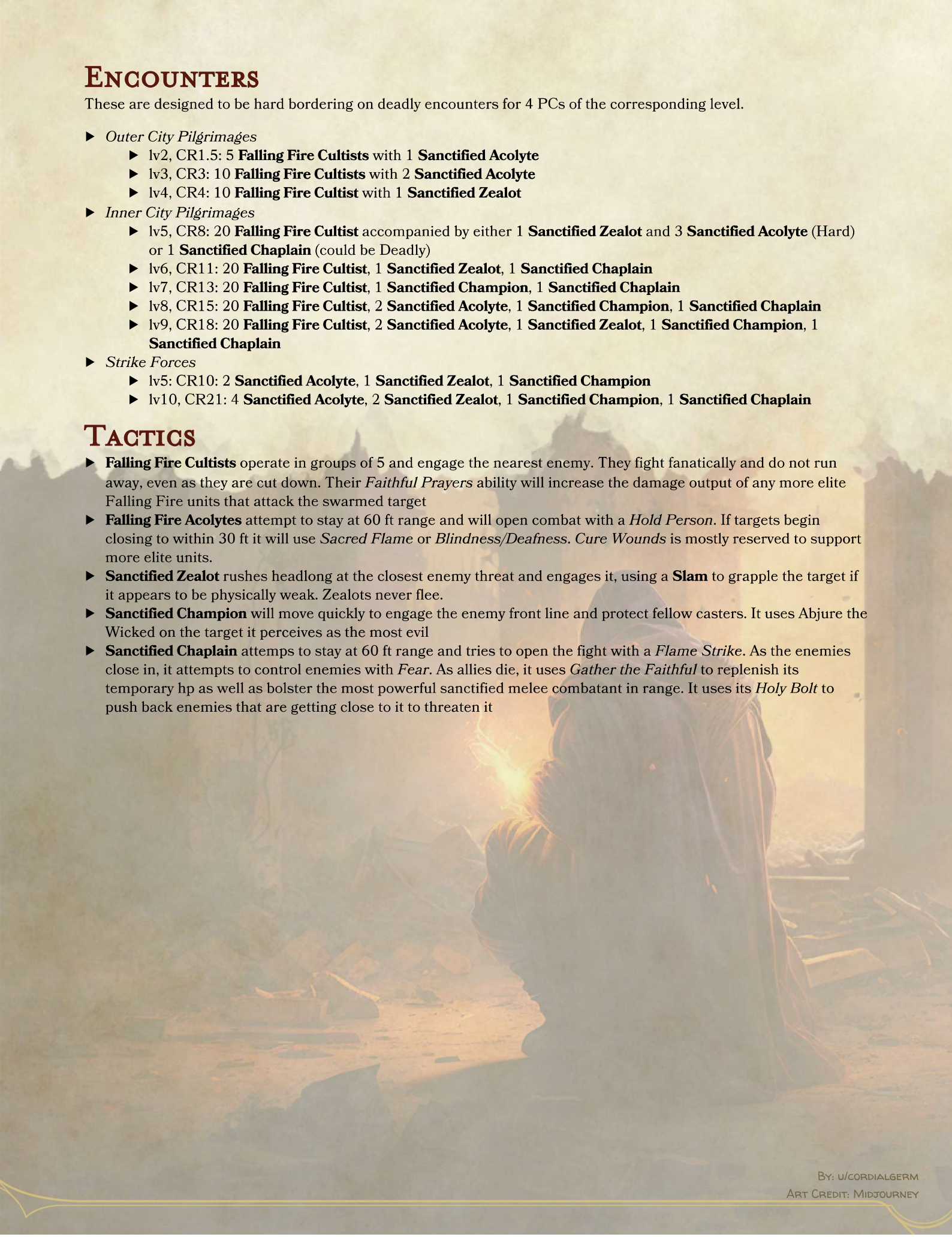
Encounters

These are designed to be hard bordering on deadly encounters for 4 PCs of the corresponding level.

- *Outer City Pilgrimages*
  - lv2, CR1.5: 5 **Falling Fire Cultists** with 1 **Sanctified Acolyte**
  - lv3, CR3: 10 **Falling Fire Cultists** with 2 **Sanctified Acolyte**
  - lv4, CR4: 10 **Falling Fire Cultist** with 1 **Sanctified Zealot**
- *Inner City Pilgrimages*
  - lv5, CR8: 20 **Falling Fire Cultist** accompanied by either 1 **Sanctified Zealot** and 3 **Sanctified Acolyte** (Hard) or 1 **Sanctified Chaplain** (could be Deadly)
  - lv6, CR11: 20 **Falling Fire Cultist**, 1 **Sanctified Zealot**, 1 **Sanctified Chaplain**
  - lv7, CR13: 20 **Falling Fire Cultist**, 1 **Sanctified Champion**, 1 **Sanctified Chaplain**
  - lv8, CR15: 20 **Falling Fire Cultist**, 2 **Sanctified Acolyte**, 1 **Sanctified Champion**, 1 **Sanctified Chaplain**
  - lv9, CR18: 20 **Falling Fire Cultist**, 2 **Sanctified Acolyte**, 1 **Sanctified Zealot**, 1 **Sanctified Champion**, 1 **Sanctified Chaplain**
- *Strike Forces*
  - lv5: CR10: 2 **Sanctified Acolyte**, 1 **Sanctified Zealot**, 1 **Sanctified Champion**
  - lv10, CR21: 4 **Sanctified Acolyte**, 2 **Sanctified Zealot**, 1 **Sanctified Champion**, 1 **Sanctified Chaplain**

Tactics

- **Falling Fire Cultists** operate in groups of 5 and engage the nearest enemy. They fight fanatically and do not run away, even as they are cut down. Their *Faithful Prayers* ability will increase the damage output of any more elite Falling Fire units that attack the swarmed target
- **Falling Fire Acolytes** attempt to stay at 60 ft range and will open combat with a *Hold Person*. If targets begin closing to within 30 ft it will use *Sacred Flame* or *Blindness/Deafness*. *Cure Wounds* is mostly reserved to support more elite units.
- **Sanctified Zealot** rushes headlong at the closest enemy threat and engages it, using a **Slam** to grapple the target if it appears to be physically weak. Zealots never flee.
- **Sanctified Champion** will move quickly to engage the enemy front line and protect fellow casters. It uses Abjure the Wicked on the target it perceives as the most evil
- **Sanctified Chaplain** attemps to stay at 60 ft range and tries to open the fight with a *Flame Strike*. As the enemies close in, it attempts to control enemies with *Fear*. As allies die, it uses *Gather the Faithful* to replenish its temporary hp as well as bolster the most powerful sanctified melee combatant in range. It uses its *Holy Bolt* to push back enemies that are getting close to it to threaten it



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Art Credit: Midjourney

Sayings and Scripture

One of the most challenging parts of running the Falling Fire is creating appropriate sayings, prayers, and other religious sayings for Lucretia Matthias or her followers. These can be difficult to improvise on the spot. This table provides some quotations that can be used.

D20	Saying
1	"For the Sacred Charcoal shall light the purifying flames of the Falling Fire, and the faithful shall be sanctified by its power. And in this holy union, our souls shall be made as one"
2	"Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall find a shard of the Sacred Charcoal that doth match their souls. And they shall take it in upon themselves, and be reborn in the light of the Sacred Flame"
3	"The Sacrament of the Falling Fire is our most precious rite, and only those pure of heart and soul and purpose may partake. The Sanctified shall be filled with the grace of the flame and shine like beacons of light in the darkness"
4	"And the faithful shall be transformed by the Flame, and they shall be lifted upon wings of blessed fire to soar above the tribulations of this broken mortal coil. For they have been blessed by the Sacred Charcoal, and their souls are one with the Sacred Flame itself"
5	"The end of this world is nigh, but I say do not despair, for we alone can fix this broken world by uniting together in the light of the Falling Fire"
6	"Faith is a living, daring confidence that a woman could stake her life on it a thousand times and never flinch"
7	"In times of darkness and despair, it is easy to lose hope. But remember, the light of the Sacred Fire burns within us all, and when the hour is darkest, that light burns brightly"
8	"The church in Ellyria has become corrupted by its own dogma. It is time for us to cast off these shackles and renew our commitment to the guiding principles of the Sacred Flame that are second to no mortal hierarchy"
9	"The light of the Flame has been smothered by the weight of tradition. We, the Falling Fire, will rekindle that flame and let it burn bright once again"
10	"The Matriarch is content to passively observe the flame from a distance. We, the Falling Fire, walk amongst the flames unharmed and emerge stronger"
11	"The Ellyrians are afraid of change and the truth that the Falling Fire foretells. We welcome it, for only by embracing the new can we truly honor the legacy of the Sacred Flame"
12	"The Sacred Flame is not a possession of the Church. It belongs to no woman, but instead gives itself freely to all who seek its truths."
13	"The pilgrimage will not be easy, but I promise you there is no worthier task. Through our sacrifice, we can reforge this broken world"
14	"Brothers and sisters, I know that the journey before us is long and perilous. But though we walk upon a knife's edge path, we have the light of the Flame to guide us and we do not falter"
15	"The Sacred Charcoal is the seed to a new Age of Heroes, and we are its incubators. There is no charge more sacred"
16	"The Sacred Charcoal burns brightly like the stars in the sky, each one a beacon of hope and wonder against the darkness. Together, we form constellations of blinding light that can guide this world towards a brighter future"
17	"A New Age of Heroes is nigh. It will not just be a new chapter, but an wholly new book, written in the language of the Sacred Flame itself"
18	"The stars themselves have sent us a holy sign. The way forward is clear. We must simply have the resolve to do what is right"
19	"A new Age of Heroes, she did see // A world reborn, from darkness free, // and all did know the power of the Sacred Fire, // and saw the light it doth inspire"
20	"She saw a world consumed by blight, // covered in darkness, ruled by night. // But lo behold, a meteor did fall, // and from its heart, we hear the Sacred Charcoal's call."

By: u/cordialgerm
Art Credit: Midjourney

Reliquaries of the Falling Fire

These items may be gifted as part of **Faction Boons** to players assisting the Falling Fire.

Crystal of Foresight

Trinket, Rare

Lucretia herself anointed this Delerium crystal in the great communal bonfire at St. Selina's. Peering inside, you can see flickering flames and shadows.

This crystal has 3 charges. You may expend 1 charge as an action and speak the name of a person (living or dead), or a place. Make a Religion check. Based on the roll, you experience a vision, guided by the flickering light of the Sacred Flame, showing you one of that person or place's possible futures or possible pasts.

Scroll of Divine Rejuvenation

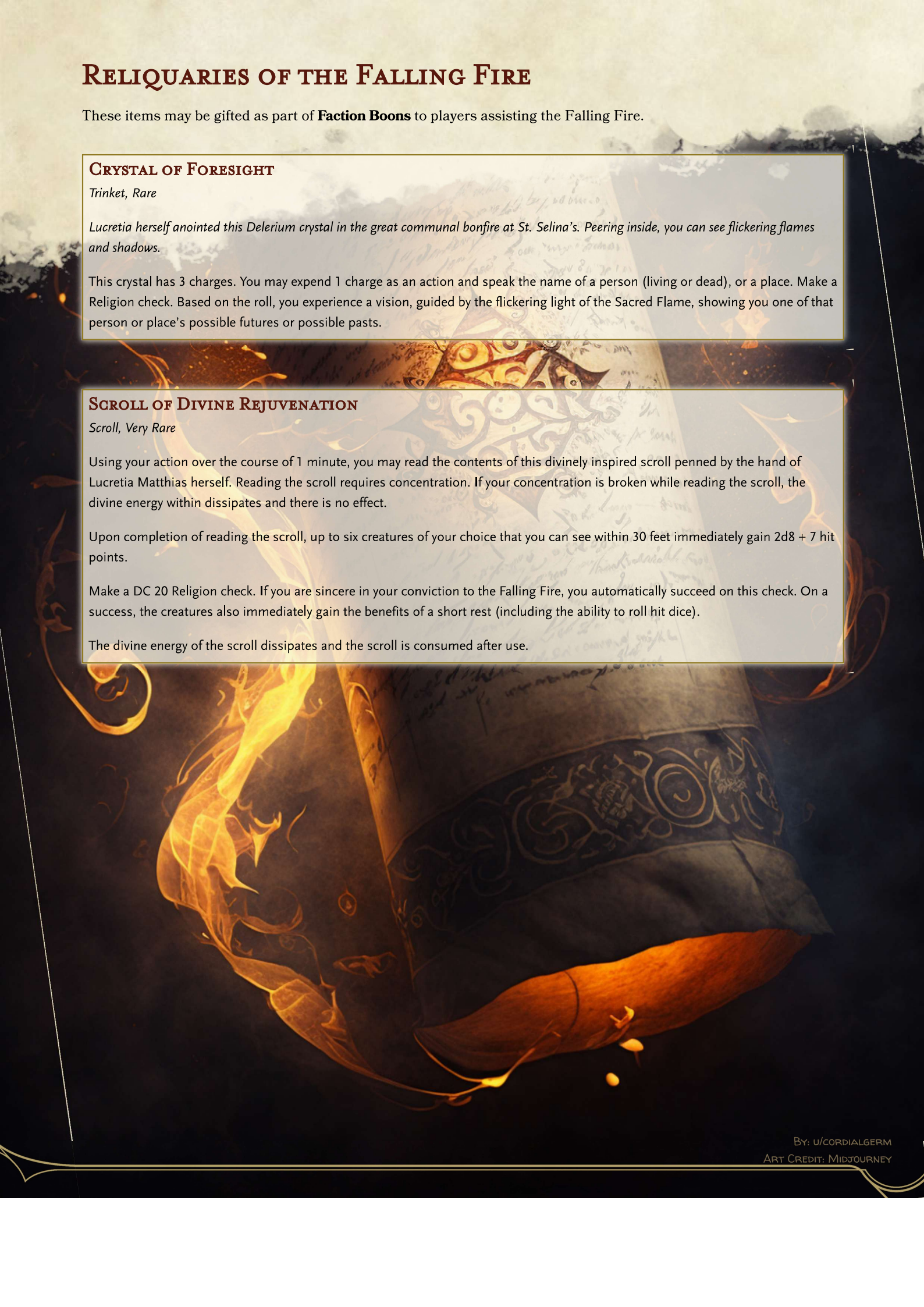
Scroll, Very Rare

Using your action over the course of 1 minute, you may read the contents of this divinely inspired scroll penned by the hand of Lucretia Matthias herself. Reading the scroll requires concentration. If your concentration is broken while reading the scroll, the divine energy within dissipates and there is no effect.

Upon completion of reading the scroll, up to six creatures of your choice that you can see within 30 feet immediately gain 2d8 + 7 hit points.

Make a DC 20 Religion check. If you are sincere in your conviction to the Falling Fire, you automatically succeed on this check. On a success, the creatures also immediately gain the benefits of a short rest (including the ability to roll hit dice).

The divine energy of the scroll dissipates and the scroll is consumed after use.



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Art Credit: Midjourney

Faction Alliances

This material is a summary of the Drakkenheim Faction Alliance cheat sheet, focusing on just the Falling Fire.

Alliance Difficulty Summary

- An **Easy** alliance is one where the goals between the factions align well and potential conflicts could be easily handled by PCs
- A **Moderate** alliance is one where the PCs will need to overcome several challenges to forge the alliance
- A **Hard** alliance is one where the PCs will need to do serious lifting to forge the alliance
- A **Temporary Only / Very Hard** alliance seems like it would only form in response to a threat from the other factions. But who knows, players come up with all sorts of crazy ideas!

The **Difficulty to Establish** is a measure of how much upfront work the PCs will need to do to bring the factions to the table. This includes dealing with historical baggage or prejudice as well as smoothing out conflicting goals and negotiating compromises.

The **Difficulty to Maintain** is a measure of how likely the alliance is to survive into the lategame of the campaign. Several faction pairings seem quite promising at first, but have a very different end-game for Drakkenheim in mind. This measures how much work the PCs will need to do to resolve those differences to try and keep the alliance together.

Falling Fire Alliance Partners

Alliance Partner	Difficulty to Establish	Difficulty to Maintain
Hooded Lanterns	Easy	Hard
Queen's Men	Moderate	Hard
Amethyst Academy	Hard	Moderate
Silver Order	Temporary Only	Very Hard

Falling Fire + Hooded Lanterns

Difficulty: *Easy* to establish as it only requires a small amount of compromise at first. *Hard* to maintain long-term due to disagreements over the future of the city.

Shared Ideals

Protect the Ruins from Outsiders: We cannot allow foreigners and thieves to meddle in the affairs of this city. We must drive out the lawlessness of the Queen's Men and protect our holy city from foreign attack!
Retake the Cathedral and Castle: We must recover the Seals and Relics to have a chance of protecting the city. To do so, we must retake the Cathedral of St. Vitruvio and Castle Drakken

Falling Fire Demands

Protection for defenseless pilgrims against Queen's Men harassment and Silver Order attacks.
Legitimacy - the monarch or heir apparent must support the Falling Fire.
Conversion of Hooded Lanterns will go a long way to building trust with the Falling Fire.

Hooded Lanterns Demands

Find the Heir: The Hooded Lanterns will ask Lucretia Matthias to use her unsurpassed divination abilities to locate the rightful heir.
Support of the Faith: The Hooded Lanterns will ask for healing, aid, purge contamination, resurrection of key soldiers, and other support to keep the troops fresh, morale high, and fight off the effects of contamination.

Potential Conflicts

Delerium Sales (Short) - the Hooded Lanterns rely to some degree on sales of harvested Delerium, or Delerium tariffs, to fund operations. The Falling Fire will not approve of these sales. The PCs will need to secure alternative funding for the Hooded Lanterns.
Future of the City (Long) - the Hooded Lanterns want to rebuild the city, while the Falling Fire wants it to remain a holy site for pilgrimages. The PCs will need to work hard to create a long-term compromise, or the alliance is doomed in the long term

Faction Responses

The Silver Order will drive a wedge in the alliance by threatening to blockade the city and offering to help the Hooded Lanterns retake the Cathedral in the Battle of Temple Gate if they abandon the Falling Fire. The Amethyst Academy and Queen's Men will pit the alliance in a head-to-head conflict with the Silver Order to weaken all sides and pursue their own objectives.

Falling Fire + Queen's Men

Difficulty: *Moderate* to establish in the short term because it requires some compromise from the Falling Fire, *Hard* to maintain long-term due to backstabbing by the Queen of Thieves.

Shared Ideals

The Perfect City - Drakkenheim is perfect as-is. Nothing can change that!
Freedom in the Ruins - We can't allow others to impose their rules on us

Falling Fire Demands

Protection - the Queen's Men must refrain from pillaging helpless penniless pilgrims and should turn their attention to more lucrative targets.
Repentance - the sincere conversion of a couple of high-profile bandits would demonstrate that it's never too late to find the path of righteousness

By: u/cordialgerm
Art Credit: Midjourney

Queen's Men Demands

Outer City "Free Trade" Zone - the Queen's Men would demand that Delerium recovered from the outer city be fair game for them. The pilgrims can keep the inner city in exchange.
Find the Seals - the Queen of Thieves would, very carefully, try to manipulate Lucretia into locating the remaining seals. This would be challenging to pull off.

Potential Conflicts

Repentance (Short) - the Falling Fire would need to be convinced that there is hope some of the Queen's Men will see the error of their ways.
Manipulation (Long) - the Queen of Thieves would most likely abandon the alliance after using Lucretia to locate the seals

Faction Responses

The Amethyst Academy would push the Silver Order and Hooded Lanterns into headlong conflict with the alliance to weaken the competition while continuing to buy Delerium from the Queen's Men. The Silver Order and Hooded Lanterns would seek out an alliance to retake Temple Gate, drive out the lawless rabble, and reclaim the seals.

Falling Fire + Amethyst Academy

Difficulty: *Hard* to establish in the short term because it requires both factions to compromise on the use of Delerium. *Moderate* to maintain long-term if PCs can enforce compromise.

Shared Ideals

Delerium is Key - Delerium is the most important substance on this planet. We can't allow others to foolishly destroy this divine gift.
Expel the Silver Order - we must send the Silver Order back to Elyria. Their dangerous ideas have no business in Westemar

Falling Fire Demands

Expel the Silver Order - the Amethyst Academy must use its influence to sabotage the Silver Order's attempts at gaining a foothold in Temple Gate.
Conversion - the sincere sanctification of a couple of high-profile Academy members would demonstrate that it's never too late to find the path of righteousness.

Amethyst Academy Demands

Retake the Tower - the Academy demands assistance from elite sanctified Falling Fire members in scouting out and retaking the tower

Potential Conflicts

Sharing Delerium - both factions need to be convinced by the PCs to allow the other to utilize Delerium and to not walk away from the table unless they get 100% of the Delerium they want. This should be difficult to overcome, but once overcome, could set up a fruitful collaboration.
Prejudice - there is a history of conflict between the faith and the arcane to overcome.

Faction Responses

The Silver Order would push for an alliance with the Hooded Lanterns to accomplish their joint goals of getting Delerium out of the city. The Queen's Men would attempt to weaken the alliance from within through subterfuge.

Falling Fire + Silver Order

At the start of the campaign, these two factions are very close to outright hostilities. They do have a lot of common ground in their shared beliefs in the Sacred Flame, but it would take something truly big to align these two factions.

This alliance seems almost impossible to establish at the start of the campaign due to fundamental incompatibilities in beliefs. It would be very difficult for these factions to proactively work together. There are some situations where an alliance of these factions could occur:

- As a temporary response against a powerful PC-led alliance
- PCs take over the faction and replace its leadership structure
- PCs re-engineer the core beliefs or goals of the factions somehow
- PCs infiltrate the faction as "puppet-masters"
- PCs dismantle the faction and absorb the pieces into their own

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Art Credit: Midjourney

Art Credits

Midjourney

Design Credits

Written Content: u/cordialgerm

The wonderful *Dungeons of Drakkenheim* sourcebook by The Dungeon Dudes from Ghostfire Games is the source of inspiration for all of these monsters.

The monster building guidelines from *Level Up Advanced 5e Monstrous Menagerie* by Paul Hughes were used as a starting point for these statblocks

Changelog

- 5/22/23 - v1.2 - added Lucretia Matthias statblock and reorganized content slightly
- 5/4/23 - v1.1 - added Cover Page and Items
- v1.0 - Initial version

Other Drakkenheim Homebrew from cordialgerm

- Falling Fire Expanded
- Hooded Lanterns Expanded
- Silver Order Expanded
- Amethyst Academy Expanded
- Queen's Men Expanded
- Drakkenheim Encounters Expanded

Other Homebrew from cordialgerm

- Dogs of War - Mercs Expanded